Specification of the controlled designation of origin "ROMANÉE-CONTI"

approved by decree no. 2011-1382 of 25 October 2011, JORF of 28 October 2011

CHAPTER I

I. – Name of the designation

Only wines meeting the specific provisions set out below may claim the controlled designation of origin "Romanée-Conti", initially recognised by the decree of 11 September 1936.

II. – Geographical denominations and complementary terms

The name of the controlled designation of origin may be followed by the term "grand cru".

III. – Colour and types of product

The controlled designation of origin "Romanée-Conti" is reserved for still red wines.

IV. – Areas and zones in which the various operations are carried out

1° – Geographical area

The harvesting of the grapes, the vinification, the elaboration and the ageing of the wines are carried out within the territory of the commune of Vosne-Romanée in the Côte-d'Or department.

2° – Delimited parcel area

The wines come exclusively from vines situated within the delimited parcel production area as approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the sessions of the competent national committee of 1 and 2 June 1988.

The National Institute of Origin and Quality lodges with the town hall of the commune referred to in 1° the graphic documents establishing the parcel boundaries of the production area thus approved.

3° – Immediate proximity area

The immediate proximity area, defined by derogation for the vinification, the elaboration and the ageing of the wines, is made up of the territory of the following communes:

- Côte-d'Or department: Agencourt, Aloxe-Corton, Ancey, Arcenant, Argilly, Autricourt, Auxey-Duresses, Baubigny, Beaune, Belan-sur-Ource, Bévy, Bissey-la-Côte, Bligny-lès-Beaune, Boncourt-le-Bois, Bouix, Bouze-lès-Beaune, Brion-sur-Ource, Brochon, Cérilly, Chambœuf, Chambolle-Musigny, Channay, Charrey-sur-Seine, Chassagne-Montrachet, Châtillon-sur-Seine, Chaumont-le-Bois, Chaux, Chenôve, Chevannes, Chorey-lès-Beaune, Clémencey, Collonges-lès-Bévy, Combertault, Comblanchien, Corcelles-les-Arts, Corcelles-les-Monts, Corgoloin, Cormot-le-Grand, Corpeau, Couchey, Curley, Curtil-Vergy, Daix, Dijon, Ebaty, Echevronne, Epernay-sous-Gevrey, L'Etang-Vergy, Etrochey, Fixin, Flagey-Echézeaux, Flavignerot, Fleurey-sur-Ouche, Fussey, Gerland, Gilly-lès-Cîteaux, Gomméville, Grancey-sur-Ource, Griselles, Ladoix-Serrigny, Lantenay, Larrey, Levernois, Magny-lès-Villers, Mâlain, Marcenay, Marey-lès-Fussey, Marsannay-la-Côte, Massingy, Mavilly-Mandelot, Meloisey, Merceuil, Messanges, Meuilley, Meursanges, Meursault, Molesme, Montagny-lès-Beaune, Monthelie, Montliot-et-Courcelles, Morey-Saint-Denis, Mosson, Nantoux, Nicey, Noiron-sur-Seine, Nolay, Nuits-Saint-Georges, Obtrée, Pernand-Vergelesses, Perrigny-lès-Dijon, Plombières-lès-Dijon, Poinçon-lès-Larrey, Pommard, Pothières, Premeaux-Prissey, Prusly-sur-Ource, Puligny-Montrachet, Quincey, Reulle-Vergy, La Rochepot, Ruffey-lès-Beaune, Saint-Aubin, Saint-Bernard, Saint-Philibert, Saint-Romain, Sainte-Colombe-sur-Seine, Sainte-Marie-la-Blanche, Santenay, Savigny-lès-Beaune, Segrois, Tailly, Talant, Thoires, Vannaire, Vauchignon, Velars-sur-Ouche,

Vertault, Vignoles, Villars-Fontaine, Villebichot, Villedieu, Villers-la-Faye, Villers-Patras, Villy-le-Moutier, Vix, Volnay and Vougeot.

- Rhône department: Alix, Anse, L'Arbresle, Les Ardillats, Arnas, Bagnols, Beaujeu, Belleville, Belmont-d'Azergues, Blacé, Le Bois-d'Oingt, Le Breuil, Bully, Cercié, Chambost-Allières, Chamelet, Charentay, Charnay, Châtillon, Chazay-d'Azergues, Chénas, Chessy, Chiroubles, Cogny, Corcelles-en-Beaujolais, Dareizé, Denicé, Dracé, Emeringes, Fleurie, Frontenas, Gleizé, Jarnioux, Juliénas, Jullié, Lacenas, Lachassagne, Lancié, Lantignié, Légny, Létra, Liergues, Limas, Lozanne, Lucenay, Marchampt, Marcy, Moiré, Montmelas-Saint-Sorlin, Morancé, Nuelles, Odenas, Oingt, Les Olmes, Le Perréon, Pommiers, Pouilly-le-Monial, Quincié-en-Beaujolais, Régnié-Durette, Rivolet, Saint-Clément-sur-Valsonne, Saint-Cyr-le-Chatoux, Saint-Didier-sur-Beaujeu, Saint-Etienne-des-Oullières, Saint-Etienne-la-Varenne, Saint-Georges-de-Reneins, Saint-Germain-sur-l'Arbresle, Saint-Jean-d'Ardières, Saint-Jean-des-Vignes, Saint-Julien, Saint-Just-d'Avray, Saint-Lager, Saint-Laurent-d'Oingt, Saint-Loup, Saint-Romain-de-Popey, Saint-Vérand, Sainte-Paule, Salles-Arbuissonnas-en-Beaujolais, Sarcey, Taponas, Ternand, Theizé, Vaux-en-Beaujolais, Vauxrenard, Vernay, Villefranche-sur-Saône, Ville-sur-Jarnioux and Villié-Morgon.

- Saône-et-Loire department: Aluze, Ameugny, Azé, Barizey, Beaumont-sur-Grosne, Berzé-la-Ville, Berzé-le-Châtel, Bissey-sous-Cruchaud, Bissy-la-Mâconnaise, Bissy-sous-Uxelles, Bissy-sur-Fley, Blanot, Bonnay, Bouzeron, Boyer, Bray, Bresse-sur-Grosne, Burgy, Burnand, Bussières, Buxy, Cersot, Chagny, Chaintré, Chalon-sur-Saône, Chamilly, Champagny-sous-Uxelles, Champforgeuil, Chânes, Change, Chapaize, La Chapelle-de-Bragny, La Chapelle-de-Guinchay, La Chapelle-sous-Brancion, Charbonnières, Chardonnay, La Charmée, Charnay-lès-Mâcon, Charrecey, Chasselas, Chassey-le-Camp, Château, Châtenoy-le-Royal, Chaudenay, Cheilly-lès-Maranges, Chenôves, Chevagny-lès-Chevrières, Chissey-lès-Mâcon, Clessé, Cluny, Cormatin, Cortambert, Cortevaix, Couches, Crêches-sur-Saône, Créot, Cruzille, Culles-les-Roches, Curtil-sous-Burnand, Davayé, Demigny, Dennevy, Dezize-lès-Maranges, Donzy-le-National, Donzy-le-Pertuis, Dracy-le-Fort, Dracy-lès-Couches, Epertully, Etrigny, Farges-lès-Chalon, Farges-lès-Mâcon, Flagy, Fleurville, Fley, Fontaines, Fuissé, Genouilly, Germagny, Givry, Granges, Grevilly, Hurigny, Igé, Jalogny, Jambles, Jugy, Jully-lès-Buxy, Lacrost, Laives, Laizé, Lalheue, Leynes, Lournand, La Loyère, Lugny, Mâcon, Malay, Mancey, Martailly-lès-Brancion, Massilly, Massy, Mellecey, Mercurey, Messey-sur-Grosne, Milly-Lamartine, Montagny-lès-Buxy, Montbellet, Montceaux-Ragny, Moroges, Nanton, Ozenay, Paris-l'Hôpital, Péronne, Pierreclos, Plottes, Préty, Prissé, Pruzilly, Remigny, La Roche-Vineuse, Romanèche-Thorins, Rosey, Royer, Rully, Saint-Albain, Saint-Ambreuil, Saint-Amour-Bellevue, Saint-Boil, Saint-Clément-sur-Guye, Saint-Denis-de-Vaux, Saint-Désert, Saint-Gengoux-de-Scissé, Saint-Gengoux-le-National, Saint-Germain-lès-Buxy, Saint-Gervais-sur-Couches, Saint-Gilles, Saint-Jean-de-Trézy, Saint-Jean-de-Vaux, Saint-Léger-sur-Dheune, Saint-Mard-de-Vaux, Saint-Martin-Belle-Roche, Saint-Martin-du-Tartre, Saint-Martin-sous-Montaigu, Saint-Maurice-de-Satonnay, Saint-Maurice-des-Champs, Saint-Maurice-lès-Couches, Saint-Pierre-de-Varennes, Saint-Rémy, Saint-Sernin-du-Plain, Saint-Symphorien-d'Ancelles, Saint-Vallerin, Saint-Vérand, Saint-Ythaire, Saisy, La Salle, Salornay-sur-Guye, Sampigny-lès-Maranges, Sancé, Santilly, Sassangy, Saules, Savigny-sur-Grosne, Sennecey-le-Grand, Senozan, Sercy, Serrières, Sigy-le-Châtel, Sologny, Solutré-Pouilly, Taizé, Tournus, Uchizy, Varennes-lès-Mâcon, Vaux-en-Pré, Vergisson, Vers, Verzé, Le Villars, La Vineuse, Vinzelles and Viré.

- Yonne department: Accolay, Aigremont, Annay-sur-Serin, Arcy-sur-Cure, Asquins, Augy, Auxerre, Avallon, Bazarnes, Beine, Bernouil, Béru, Bessy-sur-Cure, Bleigny-le-Carreau, Censy, Chablis, Champlay, Champs-sur-Yonne, Champvallon, Chamvres, La Chapelle-Vaupelteigne, Charentenay, Châtel-Gérard, Chemilly-sur-Serein, Cheney, Chevannes, Chichée, Chitry, Collan, Coulangeron, Coulanges-la-Vineuse, Courgis, Cravant, Cruzy-le-Châtel, Dannemoine, Dyé, Epineuil, Escamps, Escolives-Sainte-Camille, Fleys, Fontenay-près-Chablis, Gy-l'Evêque, Héry, Irancy, Island, Joigny, Jouancy, Junay, Jussy, Lichères-près-Aigremont, Lignorelles, Ligny-le-Châtel, Lucy-sur-Cure, Maligny, Mélisey, Merry-Sec, Migé, Molay, Molosmes, Montigny-la-Resle, Mouffy, Moulins-en-Tonnerois, Nitry, Noyers, Ouanne, Paroy-sur-Tholon, Pasilly, Pierre-Perthuis, Poilly-sur-Serein,

Pontigny, Préhy, Quenne, Roffey, Rouvray, Sacy, Saint-Bris-le-Vineux, Saint-Cyr-les-Colons, Saint-Père, Sainte-Pallaye, Sainte-Vertu, Sarry, Senan, Serrigny, Tharoiseau, Tissey, Tonnerre, Tronchoy, Val-de-Mercy, Vallan, Venouse, Venoy, Vermenton, Vézannes, Vézelay, Vézinnes, Villeneuve-Saint-Salves, Villiers-sur-Tholon, Villy, Vincelles, Vincelottes, Viviers, Volgré and Yrouerre.

V. – Grape varieties

1° – Grape varieties

a) – The wines come from the following varieties:

- main variety: pinot noir N;

- accessory varieties: chardonnay B, pinot blanc B, pinot gris G.

2° – Proportion rules on the holding

The accessory varieties are authorised only as mixed plantings within the vines. Their total proportion is limited to 5 % within each parcel.

VI. – Management of the vineyard

1° – Training methods

a) – Planting density

- The vines have a minimum planting density of 9,000 plants per hectare, with a spacing between rows less than or equal to 1.25 metres and a spacing between plants within the same row greater than or equal to 0.50 metre;

- The vines may be planted "en foule" (randomly, without rows), provided that the minimum planting density is respected and the spacing between plants is greater than 0.50 metre.

b) – Pruning rules

The wines come from vines pruned according to the following provisions:

GENERAL PROVISIONS
The vines are pruned with a maximum of 8 free eyes per plant: – either short pruning (vines trained as Royat cordon, bilateral cordon, gobelet and fan); – or single Guyot long pruning.
PARTICULAR PROVISIONS
The period for establishing the cordon is limited to 2 years. During this period, double Guyot pruning, with a maximum of 5 free eyes on each cane, is authorised. Single Guyot pruning may be adapted: – with a 2nd spur allowing the position of the cane to be alternated from one year to the next; – with a cane shortened to a maximum of 3 free eyes and a spur limited to 2 free eyes. Whatever the pruning method, the vines may be pruned with additional free eyes provided that, at the phenological stage corresponding to 11 or 12 leaves, the number of fruit-bearing shoots of the year per plant is less than or equal to the number of free eyes defined in the pruning rules.

c) – Trellising and foliage height rules

- The height of trellised foliage is at least equal to 0.6 times the spacing between rows, the height of trellised foliage being measured between the lower limit of the foliage, set at least 0.30 metre above the ground, and the upper trimming limit;

- When the vines are not trained in gobelet, they must be raised on a stake or trellised; the trellising is maintained;

- When the vines are planted "en foule", they are trained on stakes.

d) – Average maximum load per parcel

The average maximum load per parcel is set at 6,500 kilograms per hectare.

e) – Threshold of missing vines

The percentage of dead or missing vine plants referred to in Article D. 645-4 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is set at 20 %.

f) – Cultivation condition of the vine

The parcels are managed so as to ensure a good overall cultivation condition of the vine, in particular its sanitary condition and the upkeep of its soil.

2° – Other cultivation practices

a) – In order to preserve the characteristics of the physical and biological environment, which constitutes a fundamental element of the terroir:

- The permanent non-weeding and non-ploughing of the headlands are compulsory;

- Any substantial modification of the morphology, the subsoil, the arable layer or the elements that guarantee the integrity and sustainability of the soils of a parcel intended for the production of the controlled designation of origin is prohibited, with the exception of classic deep-ploughing works.

b) – Vine plantings and replacements are carried out with healthy plant material that has undergone hot-water treatment or any other method making it possible to combat flavescence dorée.

3° – Irrigation

Irrigation is prohibited.

VII. – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes

1° – Harvest

a) – The wines come from grapes harvested at good ripeness.

b) – Particular harvesting provisions

The wines come from grapes harvested by hand.

c) – Particular provisions for transport of the harvest

The harvest is protected from rain during its transport and on its reception.

2° – Ripeness of the grapes

a) – Sugar content of the grapes

Grapes with a sugar content of less than 198 grams per litre of must may not be considered to be at good ripeness.

b) – Minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume

The wines have a minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume of 11.5 %.

VIII. – Yields – Entry into production

1° – Yield

The yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is set at 35 hectolitres per hectare.

2° – Limit yield

The limit yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is set at 49 hectolitres per hectare.

3° – Entry into production of young vines

The benefit of the controlled designation of origin may only be granted to wines coming from:

- parcels of young vines only from the 2nd year following that in the course of which planting was carried out in place before 31 July;

- parcels of young vines only from the 1st year following that in the course of which grafting in place was carried out before 31 July;

- parcels of vines that have been top-grafted, at the earliest in the 1st year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, and once the parcels no longer contain any varieties other than those permitted for the appellation. By derogation, in the year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, the varieties permitted for the appellation may represent only 80 % of the planting of each parcel concerned.

IX. – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage

1° – General provisions

The wines are vinified in accordance with local, fair and constant usages.

a) – Blending of varieties

Wines produced from parcels with mixed plantings are vinified by blending the grapes.

b) – Malolactic fermentation

At the packaging stage, the wines have a maximum malic acid content of 0.4 gram per litre.

c) – Analytical standards

Finished wines, ready to be released for consumption within the meaning of Article D. 645-18-I of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, have a maximum fermentable sugar content (glucose + fructose) of 2 grams per litre.

d) – Oenological practices and physical treatments

- Subtractive enrichment techniques (TSE) are authorised within the limit of a concentration rate of 10 %;

- The use of pieces of wood is prohibited;

- After enrichment, the wines do not exceed a total alcoholic strength by volume of 14.5 %.

e) – Prohibited equipment

Continuous presses are prohibited.

f) – Vat capacity

Every operator has an overall vat capacity (vinification and storage) equivalent to at least 150 % of the volume of wine vinified for the previous year's harvest, as entered either on the harvest declaration, pro rata to the change in the holding's area in production, or on the production declaration.

g) – Upkeep of the cellar and equipment

The cellar and the equipment are well maintained; this is reflected in particular by:

- general hygiene of the elaboration premises, with general cleanliness, well-maintained floors, adequate drainage and a surface avoiding stagnation;

- harmlessness of the equipment and products coming into contact with the wine;

- separation and specificity of the premises: premises without the same functions must be separated, such as storage areas for plant-protection products, cleaning products or hydrocarbons, from the premises for vinification, ageing and storage of dry goods (corks, cartons);

- management of wine effluents: effluents must be removed as quickly as possible from foodstuff premises and deposited in well-maintained containers that are easy to clean and can be closed; waste storage areas must be kept clean; waste must be disposed of hygienically and in an environmentally friendly manner; a waste storage and removal area must be provided;

- absence of hazardous or odorous substances in the vinification, ageing and storage premises (odour).

h) – Ageing

- The wines are aged at least until 15 June of the year following that of the harvest;

- The temperature of the containers during the ageing phase is controlled and less than or equal to 25 °C.

2° – Provisions relating to packaging

For every packaged lot, the operator keeps available for the approved control body:

- the information appearing in the register of handling operations referred to in Article D. 645-18 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code;

- the reports of analyses carried out before or after packaging.

These reports are kept for a period of 6 months from the date of packaging.

3° – Provisions relating to storage

The operator provides evidence of a protected storage place for wines packaged in unlabelled bottles, with a temperature of between 5 °C and 22 °C.

4° – Provisions relating to the circulation of products and placing on the market for the consumer

At the end of the ageing period, the wines are placed on the market for the consumer from 30 June of the year following that of the harvest.

X. – Link with the geographical area

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The geographical area is situated in the "Côte de Nuits" vineyard, a linear relief of tectonic origin stretching for about 25 kilometres in a general north–south direction. The "Côte de Nuits" separates the limestone plateaux of the "Hautes Côtes" to the west, at an altitude of between 400 metres and 500

metres, from the Bresse plain to the east, a Tertiary rift valley whose altitude, level with the "Côte", is close to 250 metres.

The climate is a temperate oceanic climate, tempered by continental and southern influences, the latter coming up through the Rhône corridor. The regional oceanic character asserts itself in a moderate and regular rainfall regime (about 750 millimetres per year), with no marked summer drought. Temperatures show a certain coolness, with an annual average of 10.5 °C. The "Côte", situated east of the Morvan heights and the Burgundian plateaux, benefits from a sheltering effect from the prevailing winds, resulting in higher temperatures and reduced rainfall.

The geographical area is thus limited to the sole territory of the commune of Vosne-Romanée, between the towns of Dijon and Nuits-Saint-Georges, in the Côte-d'Or department, in Burgundy.

The slope, with a difference in height of about 150 metres, is made up of a series of Middle Jurassic limestones, including the particularly compact "Comblanchien limestone", which forms the backbone of the relief. A level of Bajocian marls (clayey limestones) is interbedded in the limestone series in the lower part of the slope, forming a slight shelf in the topography.

The parcels delimited for the harvesting of the grapes are located on the piedmont of the relief, on a gentle east-facing slope, between altitudes of 260 metres and 270 metres, in the hollow of the concavity generated by the Bajocian marl level.

The substratum is made up of these marls and, for the lower part, of "crinoidal limestones". The whole substratum is masked by a thin layer (a few decimetres to 1 metre) of colluvium mixing scree with clays and silts resulting from the weathering of the subsoil and the overlying reliefs.

The soils are little developed, generally carbonated and thin, characterised by a high clay content. They are nevertheless free-draining owing to the calcareous nature of the subsoil. The strong presence of iron oxides gives the soil a characteristic red colour.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

In the 12th century, the Cluniac monastery of Saint-Vivant, founded around the year 900 a few kilometres as the crow flies west of the "Côte", in the "Hautes Côtes de Nuits", owned at "Vosne" a wine estate received from the Duke of Burgundy HUGUES II, a harvest house and cellars. This estate was made up of 4 clos or "cloux", adjoining but distinct, very precisely recorded in a deed of 1512. The monastery kept them until the French Revolution of 1789, except for one of them, "le Cloux des 5 journaux" (the "journal" is a unit of area representing about 34 ares), or "Cros des Cloux", which was sold in 1584. It remained the property of the CROONEMBOURG family until 1760.

In the meantime, as attested by a notarial document of 1676, the vine of the "Cros des Cloux" had taken the name "Romanée", within its exact limits of 1512. Why? Nobody knows… but one cannot forget that "romenie" is an old French word, frequently found in literature, designating a mythical, legendary wine.

In 1760 the vine was sold, at a price considered extravagant for the time, to a cousin of LOUIS XV and a powerful figure, Louis-François de BOURBON, Prince de CONTI. He was to reveal it to the world, making it an instrument of his personal renown, even going so far as to give it his name! It thereafter became the "Romanée-Conti".

At the French Revolution of 1789, the last Prince de CONTI lost all his property and ended his life in exile. Confiscated and sold as national property in 1794, the "Romanée Conti" was acquired in 1819 by the OUVRARD family, already owners of the "Clos de Vougeot". The "Romanée-Conti" was vinified in the vat house of the "Clos" until 1869, when the OUVRARD heirs sold the vine to Jean-Marie DUVAULT-BLOCHET, a major landowner and wine-grower from Santenay, ancestor of the present owners.

The vine is still enclosed by walls that are a legacy of the medieval period.

In 1816, JULLIEN cited the wine of the "Romanée-Conti" in the "first class" among the "fine wines" of Burgundy. In 1860, the Comité de Viticulture of the arrondissement of Beaune also ranked it in the "1st class".

The controlled designation of origin "Romanée-Conti" was recognised by the decree of 11 September 1936.

The vines are trained according to the usages in force in the "Côte de Nuits", with planting densities above 9,000 plants per hectare and a planting based on the pinot noir N variety. Cultivation practices are geared towards optimal preservation of the soil. It is customary to age the wines long enough to ensure them a great aptitude for keeping.

The "Romanée-Conti" vineyard covers an area of about 1.80 hectares, for an average annual production of 45 hectolitres.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

More than by its power, the wine stands out for its exceptional delicacy combined with great complexity. Its personality may be defined "as a whole of great richness that defies analysis and whose unity each vintage would order according to the rules of a subtle orchestration".

Expressing intense aromas in its youth, very frequently mixing fruity notes with nuances of undergrowth or leather, the wine gradually develops its full potential of delicacy and harmony, and progressively reveals subtle scents, sometimes floral, of exceptional suavity combined with great aromatic persistence. It finally expresses the full range of its qualities only after some fifteen years of ageing.

3° – Causal interactions

Within the Burgundy vineyard, exceptional "climats" (customary names, most often the name of a lieu-dit) such as the "Romanée-Conti" have emerged over time. They extend over privileged situations where the soil and climate conditions are optimal.

Identified and named for centuries, they receive the greatest care from producers, both in the vineyard and in the cellar. Year after year they produce the most perfect wines and have for several centuries been placed at the top of the classification of the great wines of Burgundy. The term "grand cru" associated with them appeared at the beginning of the 20th century, and its indication on the label is a well-established usage.

Thus the "Romanée-Conti", situated at the heart of the vineyard of the commune of Vosne-Romanée, is ideally placed. The characteristics of its soil and subsoil ensure, over the years, a consistency in excellence. Fertile but without excess thanks to the clays, endowed with an optimal water balance through the combination of a surface layer that retains water and a limestone subsoil ensuring effective drainage, sheltered from morning mists and spring frosts by its situation slightly overlooking the plain, the site combines all the assets for the elaboration of great wines.

The pinot noir N variety, an indigenous Burgundian variety, has found in the "Romanée-Conti" its favourite natural environment. It develops its full potential here, expressed with particular finesse and elegance.

Aware of this potential, the successive owners have always been keen to make the most of this small parcel through rigorous practices, both in the vineyard and in the cellar. The wines in particular undergo long ageing, which gives them an exceptional aptitude for ageing in bottle.

Throughout its history, the vine of the "Romanée-Conti" has never been divided. It has been, from the very beginning, a monopole (unity of ownership, management and wine production), a remarkable

landholding unit clearly founded on the idea of a site identified as outstanding by the quality of its production. The "Romanée-Conti" still occupies the same area as the "Cros des Cloux" in the 16th century. It thus illustrates the typically Burgundian idea of "climat". The preservation of the old walls, on part of its perimeter, bears witness to the immutability of this clos rooted in the history of Burgundy.

Raised to the rank of the greatest wines in the world at the end of the 18th century by the Prince de CONTI, the "Romanée-Conti" has, since that time, kept its leading place among the wines of Burgundy. It is distributed in more than 30 countries across all continents. This mythical wine, together with the other wines benefiting from the term "grand cru", contributes greatly to the renown of Burgundy throughout the world.

XII. – Rules of presentation and labelling

1° – General provisions

Wines for which, under the terms of the present specification, the controlled designation of origin "Romanée-Conti" is claimed and which are presented under the said appellation may not be declared after the harvest, offered to the public, dispatched, put up for sale or sold unless, in the harvest declaration, in advertisements, on leaflets, labels, invoices and any containers whatsoever, the aforesaid controlled designation of origin is entered.

2° – Particular provisions

a) – The labelling of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin may specify the larger geographical unit "Vin de Bourgogne" or "Grand Vin de Bourgogne".

b) – The indication of the grape variety is prohibited on the labelling of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin.

CHAPTER II

I. – Declaration obligations

1. Claim declaration

The claim declaration is sent to the defence and management body at least fifteen days before circulation between authorised warehousekeepers and at the latest on 10 December of the year of harvest.

It indicates in particular:

- the designation claimed;

- the volume of the wine;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the name and address of the applicant;

- the place of storage of the wine.

It is accompanied in particular by a copy of the harvest declaration and, as the case may be, a copy of the production declaration or an extract of the stock accounts for buyers of grapes and musts.

2. Declaration prior to transaction and collections

Every operator wishing to sell in bulk a wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin makes a transaction declaration for the lot concerned to the approved control body within time limits set in the control plan of between six and fifteen working days before any collection.

This declaration, accompanied where applicable by a copy of the purchase contract, specifies in particular:

- the identity of the operator;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the identification of the lot;

- the volume of the lot;

- the identification of the containers;

- the identity of the buyer.

If collections are made for volumes smaller than those set out in the transaction declaration, the operator informs the approved control body in writing.

3. Declaration of release for consumption

Every operator declares to the approved control body each lot of wine intended to be released for consumption within the meaning of Article D. 645-18-I of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code.

This declaration may also be drawn up for lots already packaged. It is made within time limits set in the control plan of between six and fifteen working days before release for consumption or before the lots concerned are dispatched from the operator's cellars.

It specifies in particular:

- the identity of the operator;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the identification of the lot;

- the volume of the lot;

- the lot number for wines already packaged;

- the identification of the containers for non-packaged wines.

However, making available to the approved control body the register referred to in Article D. 645-18 II of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code serves as the declaration of release for consumption, under the conditions set out in the control plan.

4. Declaration relating to the dispatch outside the national territory of a non-packaged wine

Every operator wishing to dispatch outside the national territory a non-packaged wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin declares it to the approved control body within time limits set in the control plan of between six and fifteen working days before any dispatch.

5. Fallback declaration

Every operator carrying out a fallback of a wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin into a more general controlled designation of origin sends the defence and management body and the approved control body a monthly declaration at the latest on the 1st working day following the tenth day of each month.

This declaration indicates in particular:

- the identity of the operator;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the more general controlled designation of origin of the fallback;

- the volume concerned by the fallback;

- the vintage;

- the state of the lot concerned (bulk, bottle, hermetically sealed vacuum containers…);

- the date of the fallback.

The approved control body transmits without delay a copy of the monthly declaration to the approved control body for the more general controlled designation of origin concerned.

The defence and management body transmits without delay to the defence and management body of the more general controlled designation of origin concerned the list of operators who have made a monthly fallback declaration, together with a summary statement indicating:

- the more general controlled designation of origin of the fallback;

- the volume concerned by the fallback;

- the vintage(s);

- the state of the lot(s) concerned (bulk, bottle, hermetically sealed vacuum containers…).

6. Downgrading declaration

Every operator carrying out a downgrading of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin sends the defence and management body and the approved control body a monthly declaration within time limits set in the control plan. This declaration indicates in particular:

- the identity of the operator;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the volume downgraded;

- the vintage;

- the date of the downgrading.

7. Declaration of equipment for TSE

Every operator holding a concentration apparatus declares it upon purchase to the defence and management body, specifying its specifications. The defence and management body keeps an up-to-date list of operators holding such equipment and sends it each year to the services of the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the latest on 1 September.

Every operator using a service provider declares it to the defence and management body, which draws up the list of these operators and sends it each year to the services of the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the latest on 1 September.

8. Reworking of parcels

Before any development or any works liable to modify the morphology, the subsoil, the arable layer (including any addition of exogenous soil) or the elements that guarantee the integrity and sustainability of the soils of a parcel intended for the production of the controlled designation of origin, with the exception of classic deep-ploughing works, the operator sends a declaration to the defence and management body at least four weeks before the planned start date of the works.

The defence and management body transmits, without delay, a copy of this declaration to the services of the National Institute of Origin and Quality.

II. – Keeping of registers

1. General plan of the storage and vinification places

Every vinifying operator keeps up to date and available for the approved control body a general plan of the storage and vinification places, allowing in particular the number, designation and capacity of the containers to be identified.

2. TSE register

Every operator carrying out partial concentration of musts keeps an up-to-date TSE register including in particular:

- the initial volume;

- the volume of water evaporated;

- the identification of the lot after concentration (volume and potential alcoholic strength).

CHAPTER III

I. – Main points to be checked and evaluation methods

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
A – STRUCTURAL RULES	
A1 – Location of operators within the immediate proximity area	Documentary check
A2 – Belonging of the planted parcels to the delimited area	– Documentary check: up-to-date CVI parcel record; – Check in the field
A3 – Claimable production potential (grape varieties and proportion rules, planting density, plant material)	– Documentary check; – Check in the field
A4 – Processing, ageing, packaging and storage facilities	
Vat capacity	– Documentary check: general plan of the storage places; – On-site check
Ageing (temperature control and length of ageing)	– Documentary check: declaration of release for consumption or bottling register; – On-site check
State of upkeep of the cellar and equipment (hygiene)	On-site check
Protected storage place and storage conditions (T °C)	On-site check
B – RULES LINKED TO THE PRODUCTION CYCLE	
B1 – Management of the vineyard	
Pruning	Check in the field
Average maximum load per parcel	Check in the field
Cultivation and sanitary condition of the vine (sanitary condition of foliage and berries, upkeep of the soil, upkeep of the trellising)	Check in the field
B2 – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes	

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
Ripeness of the grapes	– Documentary check: records of ripeness monitoring; – Check in the field
B3 – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage	
Oenological practices or treatments (enrichment, prohibited practices…)	– Documentary check: declaration of equipment and TSE register, enrichment, acidification and de-acidification register; – On-site check
Stock accounts, analytical traceability	Documentary check: keeping of registers, analysis reports
B4 – Harvest declaration and claim declaration	
Missing vines	– Documentary check (keeping the list up to date); – Check in the field
Authorised yield	Documentary check: check of declarations, monitoring of authorisations granted by the INAO services after their investigation of the operator's individual request
VSI, volumes harvested in excess of the authorised yield	Documentary check: monitoring of destruction certificates
Claim declaration	– Documentary and on-site check: compliance with procedures and time limits, consistency with the harvest and production declarations; – Check of the release of products into circulation
C – CHECKS ON THE PRODUCTS	
Non-packaged wines (at transaction or collection)	Analytical and organoleptic examination
Packaged wines (before or after preparation for release for consumption)	Analytical and organoleptic examination
Non-packaged wines intended for dispatch outside the national territory	Analytical and organoleptic examination of all lots
D – PRESENTATION OF THE PRODUCTS	
Labelling	On-site check

II. – References concerning the control structure

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This control body is accredited in accordance with standard 45011 and approved by the INAO.

Compliance with the present specification is checked by a third-party body offering guarantees of competence, impartiality and independence, on behalf of the INAO, on the basis of an approved control plan.

The control plan recalls the self-checks carried out by operators on their own activity and the internal checks carried out under the responsibility of the defence and management body. It indicates the external checks carried out by the third-party body as well as the analytical and organoleptic examinations.

All checks are carried out by sampling. Non-packaged wines intended for dispatch outside the national territory are subject to systematic analytical and organoleptic checks.